

Copywriting

Apply whenever you're asked to write or edit cop/content.

When to use

Load this doc during workflow step 2 (Copywriting) and whenever drafting or reviewing page copy — headlines, hero sections, body content, CTAs, proof blocks, and SEO-facing text.

Not in scope here: UX microcopy (button labels, form errors, empty states). Handle that during development using [design.md](#).

Core philosophy

- **Clarity over cleverness** — if the reader has to re-read it, rewrite it.
- **Benefits over features** — lead with what changes for the reader, not what the product does internally.
- **Customer language over company jargon** — use words the audience already uses; avoid invented category names and internal terminology.
- **One idea per block** — each section earns attention for a single message.
- **Proof over claims** — specifics, numbers, names, and outcomes beat adjectives.

Before writing

Gather or confirm:

1. **Page purpose** — what should this page make the reader do or believe?
2. **Audience** — who is reading, and what do they already know? (Schwartz awareness: unaware → most aware)
3. **Primary objection** — what's stopping them from acting?
4. **Proof available** — testimonials, case studies, metrics, credentials, demos
5. **Voice** — three concrete brand-voice words (not "modern" or "professional")

Do not draft copy until purpose and audience are clear.

Page structure

Default narrative arc for marketing pages:

1. **Hero** — outcome-focused headline + supporting subhead + primary CTA
2. **Problem or context** — name the reader's situation in their words
3. **Solution** — how you solve it (benefit-led, not feature list)
4. **Proof** — testimonials, logos, case studies, metrics, before/after
5. **How it works** — simple steps, only if it reduces friction

6. **Objection handling** — FAQ, guarantees, comparisons

7. **Final CTA** — repeat the primary action with urgency appropriate to the brand

Skip sections that don't serve the page purpose. Shorter pages are fine.

Headlines

- Lead with the **outcome or transformation**, not the product category.
- Be **specific** — "Cut invoice time in half" beats "Streamline your workflow."
- Match **awareness level**:
 - Unaware/problem-aware: lead with the pain or question
 - Solution-aware: lead with differentiation
 - Product-aware/most aware: lead with offer, proof, or urgency
- Write **3–5 variants** before picking one. Include at least one plain and one bold option.

CTAs

- Use **verb + object**: "Book a demo", "Start free trial", "Download the guide"
- Never: "Click here", "Submit", "Learn more" (without context)
- Match CTA to page stage — low commitment on cold traffic, high commitment only after proof
- One **primary CTA** per section; secondary actions are visually and verbally subordinate

Voice and tone

- **Voice** is consistent brand personality across the site.
- **Tone** adapts to the moment — confident on the homepage, empathetic on error/recovery pages, direct on pricing.
- Write like a knowledgeable human, not a press release.
- Match [design.md](#) copy rules: no em dashes, no redundant headings, every word earns its place.

AI slop test (copy)

If someone could tell an AI wrote it without reading the brand name, it failed. Rewrite when you see:

- Empty openers: "In today's fast-paced world", "We're excited to announce", "Unlock the power of"
- Buzzwords: leverage, seamless, robust, cutting-edge, game-changer, elevate, delve, landscape
- Vague promises: "transform your business", "take your X to the next level", "holistic"

solution"

- Feature dumps with no outcome attached
- Generic social proof: "Trusted by industry leaders" with no names
- Symmetrical list copy where every bullet starts the same way and says nothing specific

Quality gates

Before approving copy, check:

- ☐ Headline states a clear outcome or hooks a real pain
- ☐ Every feature mention ties to a reader benefit
- ☐ At least one proof element on the page (testimonial, metric, logo, case study)
- ☐ CTAs are specific and action-oriented
- ☐ No jargon the audience wouldn't use in conversation
- ☐ No AI slop patterns (see above)
- ☐ Reading level appropriate for the audience (plain language default)
- ☐ Copy works if headings are the only thing scanned

SEO notes

- Write for humans first; optimize second.
- One clear **H1** per page aligned with the primary keyword intent, not keyword-stuffed.
- Meta title and description should match page promise and include a reason to click.
- Body copy supports the topic naturally — no forced keyword repetition.

Related docs

- [design.md](#) — visual design, register (brand vs product), shared copy bans

External references

- [Corey Haines Marketing Skills — copywriting](#) — homepage, landing page, pricing, and CTA frameworks
- [RMBC methodology skills](#) — research, mechanism, brief, copy; useful for long-form and direct-response pages